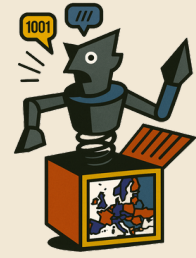


AI POP-UP LAB

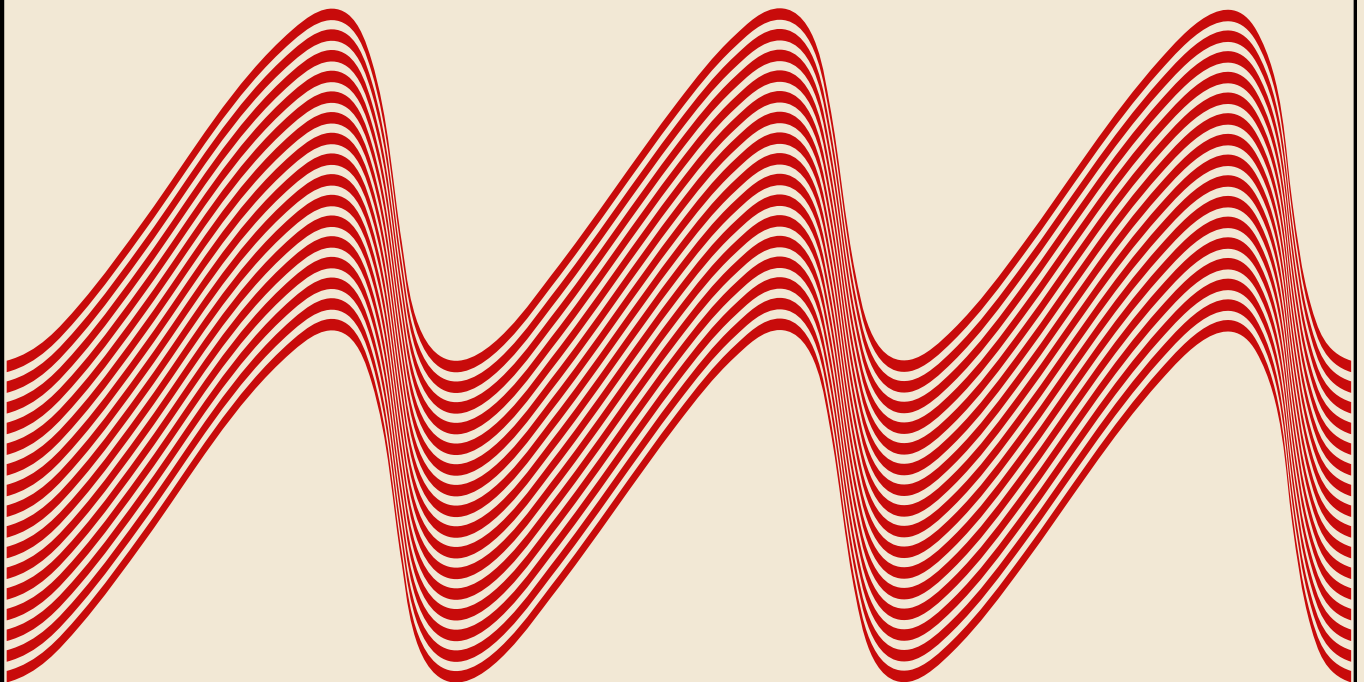


INTERVIEW PROTOCOL

NETHERLANDS FIELDWORK

BUILDING AN ARTIFICIALLY INTELLIGENT POLLSTER

www.mechanical-pollster.com



UNIVERSITEIT VAN AMSTERDAM

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Interview Guide — Netherlands Fieldwork

This guide documents the full interview procedure for the AI Pop-Up Lab Netherlands Fieldwork. It is the field companion to the Survey Codebook: the codebook documents the onboarding survey dataset, while this protocol documents how the recorded voice interviews were recruited, consented, conducted, named, and stored.

Fieldwork runs two interview tracks. A Politics track captures vote intention, issue salience, and the reasoning behind political views; an AI Task track has participants use the project's prototype polling web application and then reflects on that experience. Interviews are conducted in English or Dutch, with Dutch as the default for native Dutch speakers.

1. Before Fieldwork

Primary goal. Collect high-quality, first-person reasoning about (a) vote intention and opinion formation ahead of the parliamentary election, and (b) user mental models and risks when interacting with an AI polling web app driven by synthetic personas.

Interview types	Politics interview (vote intention & reasoning); AI interview (AI task & app experience).
Target session length	~10–15 minutes total, from consent to finish.
Target sample size	~500 participants for the Politics interview and ~100 for the AI interview.
Languages	English or Dutch.
Recording method	Full conversation recording with a voice-recording app on a tablet, and/or voice messages inside the participant's chosen messaging app (WhatsApp, Signal, or another).
Eligibility	18+; eligible to vote if the next Dutch general election were held today (Politics interview only); has a messaging app; willing to spend ~10–15 minutes.

1.1 Run-of-Show

The interviewer chooses which interview type to conduct based on recruitment needs and current progress toward targets. Once selected, follow the corresponding run-of-show below.

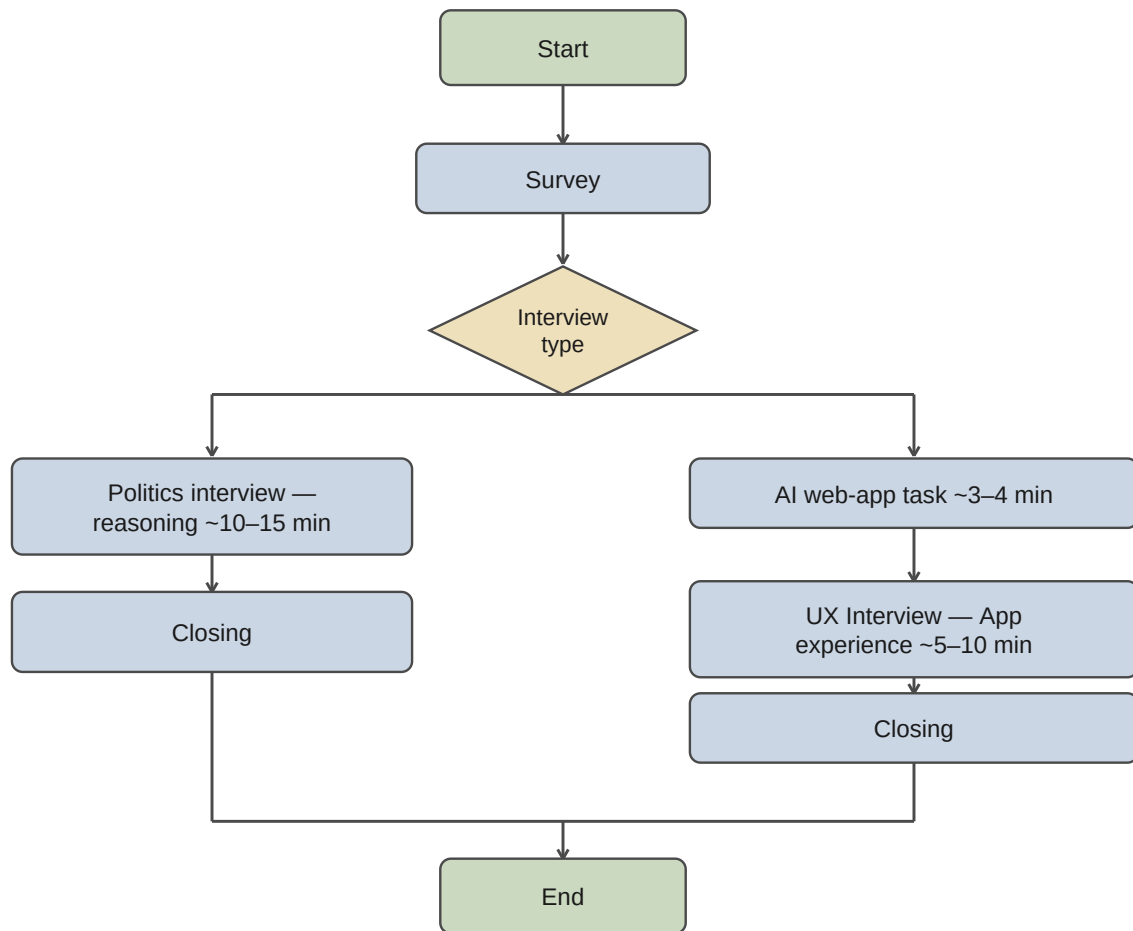


Figure 1. Run-of-show for the two interview tracks, from consent through to close.

Audio file naming follows the convention shown below; see section 6.3 for full details.

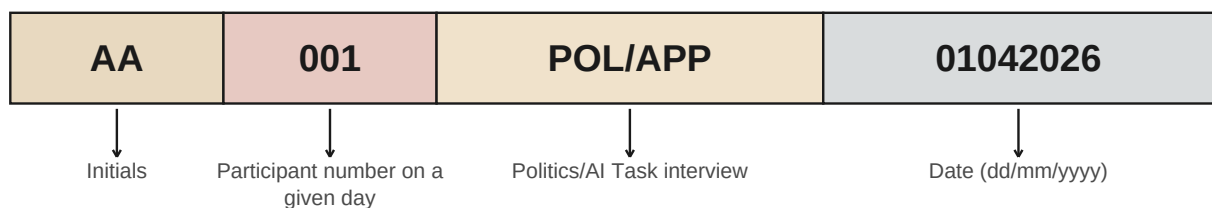


Figure 2. Anatomy of the audio file name: researcher initials, participant number, track, and date.

1.2 Minimum Viable Dataset

Politics interview

- Consent
- Onboarding survey
- Vote intention or party leaning

- Top 1–3 political issues
- At least one explanation of reasoning (why that choice)

AI Task interview

- Consent
- Onboarding survey
- Completion of the AI web-app task
- One judgment of persona similarity (plausible or not)
- One explanation of how the system works (mental model)
- One potential misconception or risk

1.3 Materials Checklist

- Tablet with: consent form, Qualtrics onboarding link, and AI web-app link/bookmark.
- Interviewer phone with WhatsApp / Signal / Telegram / e-mail installed, logged in, and able to send and receive voice messages.
- Power bank and charging cables (tablet and phone).
- Optional: earbuds to quickly check audio quality.
- Quick prompt card (1–2 pages) with:
 - Priority-1 question sequence and timebox
 - Party options list
 - Media menu (prompt list)
 - Key probes

1.4 Pair Roles and Responsibilities

Fieldwork is conducted in pairs. Each pair divides responsibilities:

Interviewer. Leads all participant-facing interactions: recruitment, consent, onboarding, and the voice interview.

Operator. Manages logistics and technical tasks so the interviewer can focus on the conversation:

- Sets up and monitors the survey, web app, and audio recordings.
- Assigns and tracks Participant IDs, researcher inputs, and approach tallies.
- Ensures all materials and recordings are correctly labelled and saved after each session.

Language pairing rule: if a person is natively Dutch, conduct the interview in Dutch even if they opt for English (social desirability bias).

1.5 Ethics & Safety

- Do not interview anyone who appears under 18. If unsure: “Are you 18 or older?”
- No pressure: accept ‘no’ immediately; do not block paths; do not follow people.
- Privacy: stand slightly aside from the main flow; keep voices low.

1.6 Fieldwork Setup & Location

Choose a location that is accessible but not too crowded, comfortable for a ~10–15 minute interaction, and relatively quiet (for audio quality). Places to target include:

- University campuses (e.g. UvA, VU, libraries)
- Public libraries
- Museum halls
- Cafés or indoor seating areas (only if relatively quiet and appropriate)
- Community spaces
- Parks

When possible, step slightly aside from the main flow of people, and offer a more comfortable spot nearby if appropriate (e.g. the edge of a square, a seating area, a café). Avoid noisy, windy, or high-interruption areas, and any situation where others may overhear sensitive responses.

Interviews may also be conducted in a café. In that case, buy participants a coffee as compensation — keep the receipt for reimbursement. For the bad-weather protocol, see section 7.11.

2. Recruitment, Screening, and Onboarding

2.1 Approach Script

Politics scenario

EN

Hi! Sorry to interrupt. We're conducting a short research study and are interviewing people in the Netherlands about their political opinions. It takes about 10–15 minutes. Would you be willing to take part? Your input would really help us understand how people think about these topics in more depth.

NL

Hallo! Sorry dat ik stoer. We doen een kort onderzoek en interviewen mensen in Nederland over hun politieke opvattingen en hoe zij hun mening vormen. Het duurt ongeveer 10–15 minuten. Zou je willen meedoen? Jouw input helpt ons beter te begrijpen hoe mensen over politiek denken.

AI web-task scenario

EN

Hi! Sorry to interrupt. We're conducting a short research study and are interviewing people in the Netherlands about their experiences with a new AI tool. It takes about 10–15 minutes. Would you be willing to take part? Your input would really help us understand how people interact with this kind of technology.

NL

Hallo! Sorry dat ik stoer. We doen een kort onderzoek en interviewen mensen in Nederland over hun ervaringen met een nieuwe AI-tool. Het duurt ongeveer 10–15 minuten. Zou je willen meedoen? Jouw input helpt ons beter te begrijpen hoe mensen met dit soort technologie omgaan.

2.2 Eligibility Screen

1. Age. "Are you 18 or older?" / "Ben je 18 jaar of ouder?"
2. Messaging app. "Do you have WhatsApp, Signal, or another messaging app where you can send voice messages?" / "Heb je WhatsApp, Signal of een andere berichtenapp, en kun je spraakberichten versturen?"
3. Language. "Are you comfortable answering in Dutch or English?" (Dutch is the default.) / "Vindt u het prettig om in het Nederlands of in het Engels te antwoorden?"

2.3 Eligibility Decisions

- If YES to all → proceed.
- If NO to age → stop immediately.
- If NO to messaging app → stop.
- If NO to language → stop.
- If not comfortable with voice recording → offer survey-only participation; do not proceed with the interview.
- If interested but no time → offer to complete the survey now and continue the interview later via messaging app (voice notes).
- If the participant ignores or declines → count as an unsuccessful approach.

Use the table below to determine whether a participant counts as a valid case in the study.

Scenario	Included	Notes
Refuses interview and follow-up	No	Exclude completely

Scenario	Included	Notes
Completes survey only (no interview, no follow-up)	No	Survey-only is not sufficient
Completes survey + agrees to follow-up (no time for interview)	Yes	Follow-up required for inclusion
Completes Politics interview (no follow-up)	Yes	Counts as complete case
Completes AI interview (no follow-up)	Yes	Counts as complete case
Completes interview + follow-up	Yes	Full participation

If eligible and willing

EN

Great, thank you! We'll start with a short consent form and a quick survey, and then move into the interview.

NL

Prima, dank u wel! We beginnen met een kort toestemmingsformulier en een snelle vragenlijst, en daarna gaan we over tot het interview.

2.4 Consent & Onboarding Flow

Follow this order:

1. Location. Input the specific location (e.g. Amsterdam Central Station).
2. Researcher tally. Record the number of successful and unsuccessful encounters.
3. Audio file name. Input the interview file name following the format InitialsParticipantID(POL/APP)Date — e.g. AA001APP23032026 for an AI task interview and AA001POL23032026 for a politics interview. Use one Participant ID per person across all materials.
4. Consent (tablet). The participant reads, ticks the boxes, and signs. Confirm understanding if needed.
5. Qualtrics onboarding survey. Up to 3 minutes. Assist only with navigation, not with answers.
6. Follow-up record. If the participant filled in the survey but agreed to be interviewed later, note their Participant ID and ensure follow-up within a week (see section 6).
7. Interview language selection. Indicate the interview language (the last question on the survey).

2.5 Recorder Setup (from tablet)

Before starting Part 1, do a 60-second recorder setup:

1. Confirm the participant has consented to audio recording (remind them they can pause or stop recording at any time).
2. Prep devices: Do Not Disturb on; battery ≥ 30%; enough storage; screen auto-lock set to ≥ 5 minutes; keep the mic unobstructed.
3. Start the tablet voice recorder (or the agreed recording method). File name: InitialsParticipantID(APP/POL)Date, e.g. AA001APP01042026 or AA001POL01042026. See section 6.3 for naming conventions.
4. At the start of the recording, say out loud: interviewer initials, Participant ID (speak it as '001'), interview type, date, and the specific location.
5. Audio check (10–15 seconds): ask the participant to say one sentence; play it back quickly (use earbuds if available).
6. Backup plan: if the recorder fails, switch to a personal device with a secure recording app. If that also fails, collect answers as WhatsApp/Signal voice notes in the thread labelled with the Participant ID.

3. Interview Part 1: Politics & Reasoning

Prioritise Blocks 1–4 in order. If behind schedule, skip the optional blocks. Aim to complete Part 1 within 15 minutes. Focus on reasoning rather than short answers: ask fewer questions but explore them in more depth, and move on once a block’s objective is met. Avoid turning the interview into a survey.

Throughout, aim to understand the participant’s background where it is relevant to their reasoning — upbringing, family, education, economic situation, social environment. Do not ask these as direct demographic questions; draw them out naturally through follow-ups, for example:

- “Was that something you grew up with or developed later?” / “Is dat iets vanuit uw jeugd of heeft u dat later ontwikkeld?”
- “Did your family or environment influence how you think about this?” / “Heeft uw familie of omgeving invloed op uw mening?”
- “Has your personal situation (work, finances, housing) shaped your view on this issue?” / “Heeft uw persoonlijke situatie (werk, inkomen, woonsituatie) invloed op hoe u hierover denkt?”
- “Is this something you’ve experienced yourself?” / “Heeft u dit zelf meegemaakt?”

3.1 Opening Script

EN

I’ll ask you questions in English. Please respond in Dutch if that’s more comfortable for you. Try to explain your reasoning step by step, like thinking out loud. There are no right or wrong answers. You can skip any question or stop at any time.

NL

Ik stel de vragen in het Engels. Je mag in het Nederlands antwoorden als dat fijner is. Probeer je redenering stap voor stap uit te leggen, alsof je hardop denkt. Er zijn geen goede of foute antwoorden. Je kunt elke vraag overslaan of op elk moment stoppen.

3.2 Block 1 — Vote Intention

Objective: capture vote intention, main reason, and alternatives.

Starter

EN

If there were a parliamentary election today, how likely is it that you would vote? If you would vote, which party would you choose? If you’re unsure, which parties are you considering? (Show the party options on paper.)

NL

Als er vandaag Tweede Kamerverkiezingen zouden zijn, hoe groot is de kans dat u zou stemmen? Als u zou stemmen, voor welke partij zou u gaan stemmen? Bij twijfel, tussen welke partijen twijfelt u? (Laat de partijopties zien op het papier.)

Probes

- What was the most important reason for that choice? / Wat is de belangrijkste reden voor deze keuze?
- Do you feel any party represents your views well? Which ones? / Heeft u het gevoel dat een partij uw standpunten goed vertegenwoordigt? Welke?
- How certain are you in your choice, on a scale from 0 to 10? / Hoe zeker bent u van uw keuze op een schaal van 0 tot 10?
- Are there any parts of your decision you feel unsure about? / Zijn er onderdelen van uw beslissing waar u zich minder zeker over voelt?

- Which other parties did you consider, and why not those? / Welke andere partijen heeft u overwogen, en waarom niet die?
- What could change your mind before the election? / Wat zou u vóór de verkiezingen van gedachten kunnen doen veranderen?
- Was there a recent trigger (news, event, personal experience) that influenced your decision? / Was er een recente aanleiding die uw beslissing heeft beïnvloed?

If the participant seems uncomfortable, offer to generalise (e.g. 'leaning toward' instead of naming a party). Move on once vote intention or leaning is clear and at least one main reason has been explained. A full party options list is given in section 3.7.

3.3 Block 2 — Issues and Vote Link

Objective: identify top issues and connect them to vote choice.

Starter

EN

What are the most important issues for you right now?

NL

Wat zijn de belangrijkste onderwerpen/thema's voor u op dit moment?

Probes

- How do those issues connect to your vote choice? / Hoe verbinden deze onderwerpen met uw stemkeuze?
- Which party handles this issue best, and why? / Welke partij kan dit probleem het beste oplossen, denkt u?
- What would 'success' look like on this issue? / Hoe zou een succesvolle oplossing eruitzien?
- Is this something you experience personally — in work, housing, finances, or daily life? / Is dit iets wat u persoonlijk ervaart?

If relevant, select one or two items from the Issue Menu (section 3.7) and ask: "How do you feel about this proposal? Good or bad idea? Why?" Move on once 1–3 issues are identified, at least one is clearly linked to a party or vote choice, and one concrete policy stance has been discussed.

3.4 Block 3 — Development of Views

Objective: understand how political views formed or changed over time.

Starter

EN

People sometimes talk about politics in terms of left and right. Where would you place yourself on a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 means left and 10 means right? What makes you place yourself there? Then: can you briefly tell me how your political views got to where they are today?

NL

Mensen spreken soms over politiek in termen van links en rechts. Waar zou u zichzelf plaatsen op een schaal van 0 tot 10, waarbij 0 links is en 10 rechts? Wat maakt dat u zichzelf daar plaatst? En: kunt u kort vertellen hoe uw politieke meningen gevormd zijn tot wat ze vandaag zijn?

Probes

- Did anything change your mind over time? / Heeft iets in de loop der tijd uw gedachten veranderd?
- Was there a specific moment or experience that influenced you? / Was er een specifiek moment of ervaring die u heeft beïnvloed?
- What has shaped your views the most? / Wat heeft uw mening het meest gevormd?

- Did your upbringing, family, work, or personal situation play a role? / Heeft uw achtergrond hier een rol in gespeeld?

Move on once at least one clear influence, change, or formative experience has been identified.

3.5 Block 4 — Opinion Formation and Media

Objective: understand where political opinions come from and which sources are trusted.

Starter

EN

How interested are you in politics in general — very interested, fairly interested, or not very interested? And where do you mainly get information about current events from? (Show the media list.)

NL

Hoe geïnteresseerd bent u in politiek in het algemeen? En waar haalt u voornamelijk uw politieke informatie vandaan? Volgt u het nieuws? (Laat de medialijst zien.)

Probes

- Which sources do you trust most, and why? / Welke bron vertrouwt u het meest, en waarom?
- Which source influenced you most recently? / Welke bron beïnvloedde u het meest recent?
- Do you actively avoid any sources? Why? / Vermijdt u bepaalde bronnen? Waarom?
- Before elections, do you notice opinion polls? How often? / Kijkt u weleens naar politieke peilingen voor de verkiezingen?

Move on once the main information sources are identified, trust or distrust is explained, and at least one recent influence pathway is described.

3.6 Optional Blocks (only if time remains)

Government performance

- How do you think the current government has performed overall? What did they do well or poorly? / Wat vindt u van de huidige overheid/coalitie? Wat hebben ze goed of slecht gedaan?

Coalition preferences

- Which parties should cooperate after the election? Any you would not want in government? / Welke partijen moeten samenwerken na de verkiezingen? Zijn er partijen die u niet in de coalitie zou willen?

3.7 Reference Tools (use as needed)

Present these tools when asked about parties, issues, or media.

Party options list

- | | |
|---|-------------------------|
| • PVV (Partij voor de Vrijheid) | • BVNL |
| • Progressief Nederland (PRO) / GroenLinks–PvdA | • SP |
| • VVD | • Forum voor Democratie |
| • NSC (Nieuw Sociaal Contract) | • Partij voor de Dieren |
| • D66 | • ChristenUnie |
| • BBB (BoerBurgerBeweging) | • SGP |
| • CDA | • DENK |
| • 50plus | • Volt |
| • Groep Markuszower | • JA21 |
| • BIJ1 | • Other / Blank |

Issue menu

Housing

- Introduce rent control in the social sector
- Give priority to local residents for social housing
- (Probe) Who should be responsible — government or market?

Healthcare

- Abolish the mandatory healthcare deductible (eigen risico)
- Reduce waiting lists in mental and physical healthcare
- (Probe) Have you personally experienced problems accessing care?

Climate & energy

- Speed up the transition to renewable energy
- (Probe) What trade-offs feel acceptable to you?

Defence & security

- Raise defence spending to meet NATO requirements
- (Probe) Do you feel safer or less safe now?

Media menu

- Public broadcaster (TV/radio): NOS Journaal (NPO1), EenVandaag, NPO Radio 1, BNR Nieuwsradio, Ongehoord Nederland, talkshows.
- Commercial TV: RTL Nieuws, SBS Nieuws.
- Free news online/app: Nu.nl, NOS.nl, RTLnieuws.nl, AD.nl, Telegraaf.nl.
- Newspapers: AD, De Telegraaf, de Volkskrant, NRC, Trouw, Expatica.
- Podcasts: BNR, NPO podcasts.
- Social media: Facebook, Instagram, X/Twitter, TikTok, YouTube, Reddit, Snapchat, Bluesky.
- Messaging groups: WhatsApp, Signal, Telegram.
- International media: BBC, The Guardian, CNN, Al Jazeera.

Probe toolbox

Clarification

- Can you say more about that?
- What do you mean by that exactly?
- Could you explain that a bit further?

Examples and grounding

- Can you give a concrete example?
- Has this happened to you or someone you know?
- Was there something specific in the news or your life that influenced this?

Alternatives and contrast

- What would someone who disagrees say?
- Why don't you agree with that perspective?
- Which other parties did you consider, and why not?

Linking ideas

- How does that connect to your vote choice?
- How does that relate to the issues you mentioned earlier?

Immigration & asylum

- Introduce stricter asylum policy
- (Probe) What does 'integration' mean to you in practice?

Economy & cost of living

- Lower taxes
- Reduce income differences in society
- (Probe) How has your financial situation changed recently?

Agriculture

- Fairly compensate farmers who must reduce
- (Probe) How do you balance nature and farming interests?

Education

- Reduce class sizes in primary schools
- (Probe) What should schools prioritise?

Reasoning ('why')

- What makes you think that?
- Why is that important to you?
- How did you come to that conclusion?

Process and change over time

- When did you first start thinking this way?
- Has your view changed over time? What caused that?
- Was there a specific moment or experience?

Uncertainty / strength of opinion

- How certain do you feel about this?
- What would make you change your mind?
- Are there parts of this you feel unsure about?

Refocusing (if off-topic)

- That's helpful — could we go back to [topic]?
- How does that relate to your political views or decision?

4. Interview Part 2: AI Task and App Experience

4.1 Introduction to the AI Task

EN

Now we'll start with a short task using an AI tool.

NL

Nu beginnen we met een korte taak met behulp van een AI-tool.

Prioritise Blocks 1–3. If behind schedule, complete only these core blocks. Aim to complete Part 2 within 4–5 minutes.

4.2 AI Web-App Task

Hand the participant the tablet with the AI polling web app open. Read the instruction verbatim:

EN

Please search for a persona that is as similar to you as possible. Then look at the predicted voting probabilities and examine the reasoning or explanation. A persona might describe someone's age, location, and opinions — you are just looking for one that feels closest to you.

Assist only if the participant has difficulty navigating the interface, and ensure the task is completed before proceeding. If the participant does not understand 'persona', clarify: "By persona, we mean a profile of an artificial person with certain characteristics. Try to find one that feels similar to you." Then transition: "I'd like to ask a few questions about your experience using the app."

4.3 Block 1 — Plausibility and Similarity

Objective: assess whether the persona feels realistic and similar to the participant.

Starter

EN

Did the persona feel similar to you? What felt accurate or inaccurate?

Probes

- Did you feel like you were talking to a real person or an artificial model? What gave you that impression?
- Did the avatar or profile image affect how you felt about the profile? What did it suggest?
- Did the label 'Persona 1' mean anything to you? What did you think it referred to?
- Do you think it is based on real respondents, collected data, or AI-generated guesses? Why?

Move on once the participant has given a clear judgment of similarity and explained their reasoning.

4.4 Block 2 — Mental Model

Objective: understand (a) how the participant interprets what the app is and does, and (b) how they reason about AI systems more broadly.

Starter

EN

How would you describe this tool in your own words? What do you think it is and what does it do? How do you feel about that?

Probes

- If you had to compare this AI public-opinion pollster to something else, what would it be?
- How do you picture what is inside the system?
- Does it feel like the tool is serving you, or doing something of its own?
- Would you feel comfortable acting on what it tells you?
- Would you trust the outputs of this app, and what would that trust be based on?
- Point to a specific signal (e.g. the 'Not a Real Person' header or a citation tag): what does this tell you? Does it change how you'd describe what the tool is doing?
- Imagine someone unfamiliar with AI asks what this tool does — how would you explain it in a few sentences?

Move on once the participant has articulated a clear understanding or assumption about what the system is and how it works.

4.5 Block 3 — Misconceptions and Harms

Objective: identify misunderstandings and potential risks.

Starter

EN

What do you think people could misunderstand about this tool?

Probes

- Which misunderstanding would be most harmful? What would those harmful effects look like?
- What should the app say or do to prevent this?
- Is there anything in how the app looks or is presented that might make someone think these are real people's opinions?
- What might people misunderstand about the goal of the app?

Move on once at least one clear misconception and its potential impact have been identified.

4.6 Optional Blocks (only if time remains)

- Uncertainty: Did the app communicate uncertainty clearly? What could it do better?
- Sharing and behavioural effects: Would you share these results with others? How confident would you feel repeating them?
- Versioning: If the model changes over time, what information would you need to understand those changes?
- Ask-the-persona chat: Did it feel like talking to a real person? What influenced that feeling?
- Transparency: Did you notice any disclaimer? What did it communicate to you?
- Accessibility and flow: Was anything confusing or difficult to navigate or understand?
- Mental-model shift: Has your understanding of the tool changed from when you first saw it?

5. Closing

5.1 Closing Script

EN

That's everything — thank you for your time. We really appreciate your input. Remember, you can withdraw your participation at any time by contacting us at r.cerina@uva.nl. If you agreed to follow-up, we may contact you via your chosen messaging app up to 5 times. You can opt out at any time by letting us know you do not want any more messages.

NL

Dat is alles — bedankt voor uw tijd. We waarderen uw bijdrage enorm. Vergeet niet dat u zich op elk moment kunt terugtrekken via r.cerina@uva.nl. Als u heeft ingestemd met opvolging, kunnen we maximaal 5 keer contact met u opnemen via de berichtenapp die u heeft gekozen. U kunt zich op elk moment afmelden door aan te geven dat u geen berichten meer wilt ontvangen.

5.2 Post-Interview Checklist

- Confirm that the Qualtrics response has been saved.
- Note the Participant ID.
- Do not store names in interview notes — use the Participant ID only in notes, file names, and message threads. If a name is accidentally recorded, remove or redact it as soon as possible.

6. Recontact and Follow-Up Procedures

Follow-up is organised differently depending on the type of recontact. For short-term follow-up after a survey-only response, follow-up is organised at the level of fieldwork pairs: each pair is assigned one SIM-enabled device, and the Recontact Lead for that device manages communication with participants that pair recruited. For longer-term panel recontact, follow-up may be conducted by a future research team; responsibility must be clearly assigned to one designated researcher before contact begins. In all cases, follow-up is optional and only permitted if the participant explicitly agreed to be contacted again.

Consent and setup

- Only contact participants who agreed to follow-up.
- Use the participant's chosen messaging app (e.g. WhatsApp or Signal).
- Label the thread with the audio file name + number of recontact attempts, e.g. AA001POL23032026FU01. See section 6.3 for naming conventions.

Frequency

- If a participant outright rejects participation, stop all contact.
- If there is no response to the initial message, contact up to 3 times maximum.
- Do not send multiple messages in a short period — space them appropriately.

6.1 Survey-Only Response Scenario

For participants who completed the survey but chose to do the interview later, send the first follow-up within 24–48 hours of the initial interaction. If there is no response, make further attempts every 2–3 days, up to a maximum of 3 total. After 3 attempts with no response, stop and mark the participant as non-responsive.

Sample initiating message

EN

Hi! This is [initials] from the AI Pop-Up Lab — you participated in our study “Building an Artificially Intelligent Opinion Pollster” on [date]. Thank you again for completing the survey. You mentioned you would be open to completing the interview at a later time. We’d like to follow up with a short interview: we’ll send up to 5 messages, and for each one you can respond with a 1–2 minute voice message, at your own pace. Would you be open to this? If so, we’ll send the questions shortly. Thank you in advance for helping science move forward!

NL

Hallo! Dit is [initials] van het AI Pop-Up Lab — je hebt op [date] deelgenomen aan ons onderzoek “Building an Artificially Intelligent Opinion Pollster”. Bedankt nogmaals voor het invullen van de vragenlijst. Je gaf aan open te staan om het interview later af te ronden. We sturen je maximaal 5 berichten, waarop je telkens kunt reageren met een spraakbericht van 1–2 minuten, wanneer het jou uitkomt. Zou je hiervoor openstaan? Alvast bedankt voor je bijdrage aan dit onderzoek!

6.2 Panel Recontact Protocol

For participants who completed the interview and agreed to be contacted again, follow-up timing is determined by the contact-list manager and may occur at a later stage when additional data is required. All communication must follow the same ethical and data-handling standards as the initial fieldwork. Only participants who explicitly consented to future contact may be recontacted.

6.2.1 Initiating Contact

Sample initiating message

EN

Hi! This is [initials] from the AI Pop-Up Lab — you previously participated in our study “Building an Artificially Intelligent Opinion Pollster” on [date]. Thank you again for taking part. You indicated you would be open to being contacted again. We’d like to follow up with a short re-interview: up to 5 messages, each answered with a 1–2 minute voice message at your own pace. Would you be open to participating? If so, we’ll send the questions shortly. Thank you in advance for helping science move forward!

NL

Hallo! Dit is [initialen] van het AI Pop-Up Lab — je hebt eerder deelgenomen aan ons onderzoek “Building an Artificially Intelligent Opinion Pollster” op [datum]. Bedankt nogmaals voor je deelname. Je gaf aan open te staan om opnieuw benaderd te worden. We sturen je maximaal 5 berichten, elk te beantwoorden met een spraakbericht van 1–2 minuten. Zou je hieraan willen deelnemen? Alvast bedankt voor je bijdrage aan dit onderzoek!

6.2.2 Follow-Up Questions

Once a participant agrees, send the following questions one by one. The sequence follows the Schwarz model of survey response: comprehension, retrieval of accessible information, attitude construction, and judgment/formatting.

Framing (comprehension)

EN

In this study we’re interested in how you think through your vote choice for the Tweede Kamer — not just who you would vote for, but the full process of how you get there. Please speak as freely and in as much detail as feels natural. There are no right or wrong answers.

NL

In dit onderzoek zijn we geïnteresseerd in hoe u nadenkt over uw stemkeuze voor de Tweede Kamer — niet alleen op wie u zou stemmen, maar het hele proces van hoe u daar komt. We stellen het op prijs als u zo vrijuit en gedetailleerd mogelijk antwoordt. Er zijn geen goede of foute antwoorden.

Q1 — Information consumption (accessible information)

EN

Thinking about the past few weeks, what news or events have been on your mind? Please take a moment before you answer. We’re interested in everything that comes to mind, including where you came across it.

NL

Als je terugdenkt aan de afgelopen weken, welk nieuws of welke politieke gebeurtenissen hebben je beziggehouden? Neem even de tijd. We zijn geïnteresseerd in alles wat in je opkomt, inclusief waar je het bent tegengekomen.

Q2 — Voting strategy (accessible information)

EN

Most people don't think much about how they decide who to vote for — they just do it. We're curious about that process itself. When deciding who to vote for, how much do you look into the parties or candidates beforehand? Do you actively seek out information, rely on what you already know, or somewhere in between? And do you compare parties on the same issues, or focus mainly on one or two that already appeal to you? Tell us what that process looks like for you.

NL

De meeste mensen staan er niet zo bij stil hoe ze beslissen op wie ze stemmen — ze doen het gewoon. Wij zijn juist benieuwd naar dat proces. Hoeveel verdiep je je van tevoren in de partijen of kandidaten? Zoek je actief informatie op, vertrouw je op wat je al weet, of zit je daartussenin? En vergelijk je partijen op dezelfde onderwerpen, of richt je je vooral op één of twee die je al aanspreken? Vertel ons hoe dat proces er voor jou uit ziet.

Q3 — Reasoning and weighting (attitude construction)

EN

When you think about which parties you'd consider voting for, what actually goes through your mind? Walk us through it. You might touch on which parties come to mind, how well their programme fits your values, specific policies you care about, your impressions of the party leaders, which parties have a realistic shot at winning, what people you trust have said, and anything else that shapes your thinking.

NL

Als je nadenkt over welke partijen je zou overwegen, wat gaat er dan door je hoofd? Neem ons mee in je gedachten. Je kunt het hebben over welke partijen bij je opkomen, hoe goed hun programma bij jouw waarden past, specifieke beleidspunten, wat je van de partijleiders vindt, welke partijen een realistische kans hebben, en wat mensen die je vertrouwt erover hebben gezegd.

Q4 — Vote choice (judgment and formatting)

EN

Taking everything you've just talked about into account: if a Tweede Kamer election were held today, which party would you vote for? Tell us in detail why this party specifically, and what goes through your mind as you bring all your considerations together into an actual choice. How well does this party reflect what you're really looking for, and how certain do you feel about it? (Present the party options list.)

NL

Als je alles wat je net hebt verteld meeneemt: als er vandaag Tweede Kamerverkiezingen waren, op welke partij zou je dan stemmen? Vertel ons in detail waarom precies deze partij, en wat er door je hoofd gaat als je al je overwegingen samenbrengt tot een keuze. Hoe goed weerspiegelt deze partij wat je echt zoekt, en hoe zeker voel je je? (Toon de partijopties.)

Response handling: send the questions one by one, each as a separate message. Ask the participant to open and read a question only when ready to answer, and not to read ahead — this yields the most natural, spontaneous responses.

6.3 Data Naming and File Management

Messaging thread naming and audio file naming serve different purposes and are handled separately. The chat name tracks communication and follow-up attempts; the file name is for storing and analysing recordings. These need not be identical, but must share the same Participant ID, interview type, and date for linkage.

6.3.1 Messaging Thread Naming

Format: ParticipantID + InterviewType + Date + FU##, e.g. AA001POL01042026FU01.



Figure 3. Messaging thread name: the audio code plus a follow-up attempt counter (FU01, FU02, ...).

- Use the same thread for all follow-up communication with that participant.
- Increment the FU number with each recontact attempt (FU01, FU02, FU03).
- This is used to track non-response; after 3 attempts with no response, stop contacting.
- Do not include WhatsApp file names in the chat title.

6.3.2 Audio File Naming

Messaging apps such as WhatsApp auto-name voice messages as PTT-YYYYMMDD-WAXXXXXX. When exporting or saving recordings, prepend the Participant ID, interview type, and date to the original file name. Format: ParticipantID + InterviewType + Date + "_" + original file name, e.g. AA001POL01042026_PTT-20260312-WA000001.

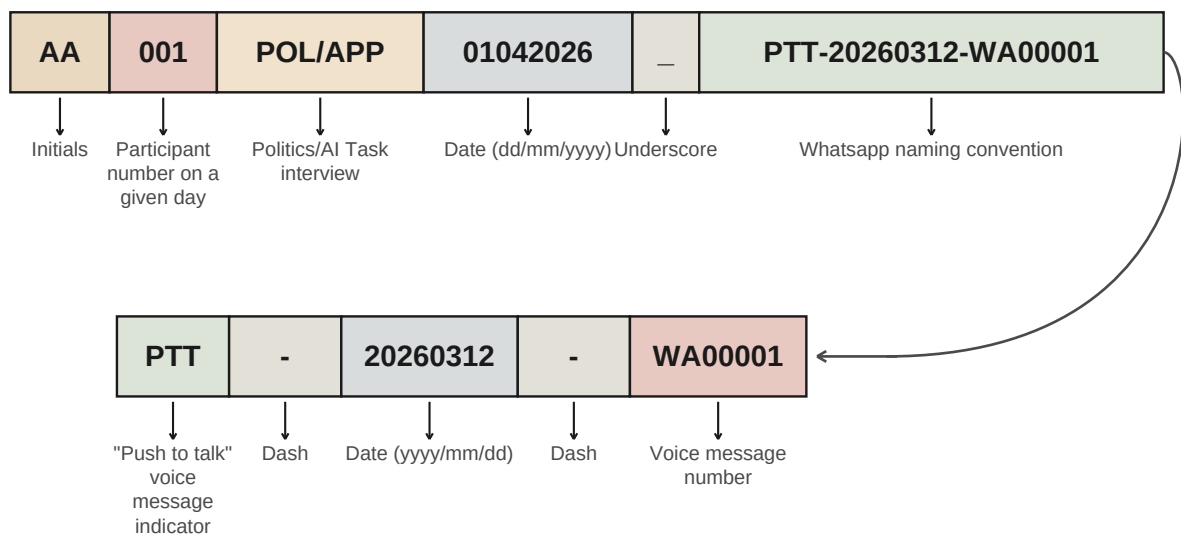


Figure 4. Saved recording name: the participant prefix prepended to the original WhatsApp file name, which itself decomposes into the push-to-talk tag, date, and voice-message number.

- Always preserve the original WhatsApp file name.
- Do not edit or remove the PTT portion — this retains the timestamp information.
- Use the same Participant ID and date as in the messaging thread.

6.3.3 Saving and Storage Procedure

After collecting recordings:

- Download all voice messages from the messaging app to the device.
- Immediately transfer files to the designated research drive, in the correct folder.
- Ensure all files are correctly renamed before uploading.

- Do not leave recordings stored only on personal devices.

Send after all recordings are downloaded

EN

Thank you so much for participating — your contribution is greatly appreciated. As a precaution for data security, we'd ask you to delete this conversation from your device after reading. Please also be aware that WhatsApp processes data through third-party services.

NL

Hartelijk dank voor uw deelname — uw bijdrage wordt zeer gewaardeerd. Als voorzorgsmaatregel voor de gegevensbeveiliging vragen wij u vriendelijk dit gesprek na het lezen van uw apparaat te verwijderen. Houd er ook rekening mee dat WhatsApp gegevens verwerkt via diensten van derden.

7. Troubleshooting and Contingency Plan

General principle: participant welfare and interviewer safety come first. If in doubt, pause or stop and leave the situation. Never pressure participation; participants may skip any question or stop at any time.

7.2 Recruitment and Eligibility Problems

- If a participant may be under 18, do not proceed until age is confirmed; if they are unsure or refuse to answer, thank them and end.
- If not eligible to vote, not living in the Netherlands, or unable to answer in Dutch or English, thank them and end.
- If a participant is intoxicated, visibly distressed, or in an active conflict, do not proceed.
- If friends or family are influencing answers, suggest moving aside; if privacy is still inadequate, stop the interview.

7.3 Consent, Withdrawal, and Privacy

- If a participant has questions about the study or data use, pause and explain using the consent form; continue only if they clearly agree.
- If they ask to stop recording, stop immediately; ask whether to continue without recording or to end.
- If they want to skip a question, acknowledge and move on without asking why.
- If they share highly sensitive information (health, trauma, illegal acts), do not probe; gently steer back and remind them they may skip any question.
- If they later request deletion or withdrawal, direct them to r.cerina@uva.nl and record the Participant ID only.

7.4 Safety in Public Spaces

- If the environment is too noisy, windy, or crowded, move 5–20 metres to a quieter spot if possible.
- If a bystander becomes aggressive or disruptive, end the interaction and leave; contact Roberto if needed. In immediate danger, call 112.
- If police, venue staff, or security ask questions, be polite, explain the study briefly, and comply with venue rules. Relocate if requested.

7.5 Technical Failures

- If the tablet battery is too low or unreliable, switch to the phone only if using a secure recording app; otherwise do not begin.
- If the recorder fails or storage is full, switch immediately to the backup method and repeat a short audio check.
- If the AI web app fails to load or crashes, skip the task and use a hypothetical framing: “Imagine an app like this that predicts vote probabilities for personas”, then continue with the core questions on plausibility, mental model, and harms.

7.6 Time Overruns

- If the session is running long, complete Priority-1 questions only.
- If the participant must leave early, prioritise vote intention or leaning, top issues, main information sources, and one reaction to the AI tool.
- Thank the participant and close politely.

7.9 Distress, Conflict, and Sensitive Topics

- If a participant becomes upset or uncomfortable, pause and offer to skip the question or stop the interview.

- If asked for the interviewer's own political opinion, remain neutral: "I'm here to learn how people think; I don't share my own views in the study."
- If a participant feels judged, reassure them there are no right or wrong answers.
- If there is any indication of immediate risk of harm to self or others, stop and prioritise safety; if urgent, call 112 and follow institutional safeguarding procedures.

7.10 Device Loss, Theft, or Data Exposure

- If a phone or tablet is lost or stolen, stop fieldwork and inform Roberto immediately.
- Follow the device security plan (section 8.5). Document what may have been exposed: device, file names, Participant IDs, and any actions taken.

7.11 Weather, Site, and Public Enquiries

- If the site does not allow recruiting, interviewing, or recording, comply immediately and relocate.
- If members of the public or journalists ask what you are doing, give the short public description from the consent form and do not share participant details.
- If weather affects comfort or audio quality, move indoors where possible (libraries, cafés, stations, quiet halls). If none is available, pause recruitment until conditions improve.
- On unstable-weather days, identify a nearby indoor backup before starting, and consider starting indoors. If weather changes mid-interview, pause the recording, move, and resume.

8. Device Security Plan

This section outlines how to securely handle tablets, phones, and recordings during fieldwork, to prevent unauthorised access, data loss, or accidental exposure of participant information.

8.1 Devices Used

Each fieldwork pair is issued one password-protected university tablet, the primary device for consent and survey (Qualtrics), audio recording, and the AI web app (via the Ecosia browser). A secure recording app is used on all devices.

Personal devices may only be used as a backup if the recording fails, and only if:

- On Apple devices: recordings are not synced to iCloud or any cloud storage.
- On Android devices: the same approved recording app is installed and is not linked to any cloud storage.

If a personal device is used, transfer files to the research drive as soon as possible, delete local copies after transfer, and never store recordings in personal cloud backups.

8.2 General Rules

- Always use the tablet as the primary device.
- Use the Participant ID only — do not store names in recordings, file names, or notes.
- Only collect data necessary for the study.
- Do not mix study data with personal files, photos, or messages.

8.3 Handling Devices in the Field

- Keep the tablet and phone with you at all times; do not leave devices unattended in public.
- When not in use, keep devices in your hand or in a closed bag.
- Only the interviewer and operator should handle the devices.
- Participants may hold the tablet only for survey completion and the AI task; before handing it over, ensure only the relevant app or page is visible.

8.4 Recording and Storage

- Start recording only after confirming consent, and check the correct Participant ID is in the file name.
- After each session, save the recording correctly and link it to the right Participant ID.
- At the end of the day, upload all recordings to the designated research drive and check that files are correctly named.
- After confirming upload, delete recordings from the device. Do not send recordings via personal email, AirDrop, or unapproved apps.

8.5 Loss or Theft

- Stop fieldwork immediately.
- Inform the faculty responsible for the device as soon as possible.
- Report what data may have been on the device (Participant IDs, recordings, apps used).
- Do not attempt to recover the device yourself.

Appendix A: Survey Question Naming Conventions

Survey items are tagged with a language suffix (_en / _nl). The administrative variables carry no suffix.

Tag	Meaning
lang	Survey language (EN/NL)
consent_en / consent_nl	Participation consent
consent_followup_en / _nl	Consent to follow-up
vote_2025_en / _nl	Voted in 2025 elections
vote_2025_party_en / _nl	Party voted (2025)
vote_likelihood_en / _nl	Likelihood to vote (1–10)
vote_today_party_en / _nl	Current vote preference
news_time_en / _nl	Daily news consumption time
gender_en / _nl	Gender
birth_year_en / _nl	Year of birth
municipality_en / _nl	Municipality
education_en / _nl	Education level
email_en / _nl	Email (re-contact)
contact_en / _nl	Messaging/contact method
res_attempts	Prior unsuccessful approaches
res_city	Sampling city
res_audio	Audio file code
res_interview_lang	Interview language